Chapter 3: Two Roads

Two people are awake in a world of stone. In Chapter 3 they become four, and then three. Teo wakes his friend Mira, an artist who can sew, paint and make almost anything with her hands. Together they build a lab at the foot of the Elder Tree, with shelves of labelled clay pots. Then Teo brings home a stone giant. The man they wake wants a very different new world. He leaves with all their revival fluid and a warning, and the three of them set out over the eastern mountains, toward the green ring, until they reach a river, a rope bridge, and a village on the far side.

"Wake one more of them, and I'll come back for every one of you."

STORY From your outline, filled in

START Carries on from the Chapter 2 save

LENGTH 3 days, about twice Chapter 2

NEXT Your changes, then building

Twenty story steps in four parts. Things marked **HURDLE** stand in your way, and **VIDEO** marks a scene you watch. Every step keeps the rule from Chapter 2: the card says what to do, the waypoint shows where, and the kit and field notes say how.

THE PEOPLE

Who is in this chapter

ALREADY AWAKE

Teo, the runner

GEOLOGIST · FAST ON HIS FEET

He was running for the cave when the light came. He knows rocks and minerals, so he can tell you where to dig and what a stone is. In this chapter he is the one who finds the stone giant, and the one who talks you into waking him.

WAKES IN PART 1

Mira, the artist

PAINTER · SEWS · MAKES THINGS

Teo's friend. She drew the pictures for his cave survey, and she sewed their tents. She is the stone woman just outside the cave, arms over her face: she was right behind Teo when he ran. She paints the labels on the lab's pots, braids rope, sews bags, and paints you a map.

"Give me fibre and a sharp bone, and I can make you anything."

WAKES IN PART 3

Garron, the stone giant

FIGHTER · VERY STRONG · VERY SURE OF HIMSELF

A huge man Teo finds near the Tiger's Gorge. Strong enough to carry a log alone and kill a boar with his hands. He helps for one day and makes you stronger, then he turns: no more waking ordinary people, only the strong, and everyone else works for him.

"The old world was weak. This one doesn't have to be."

SEEN ONCE, IN THE DARK

Garron's three

FOR CHAPTER 4

With the fluid he stole, Garron wakes three people of his own choosing, deep in the jungle: a master archer, a fighter who moves like a ninja, and a man even bigger than he is. We only see them for a moment. They come back later.

THE STORY

Twenty steps over three days

Part 1 · Mira

Day 1, morning. Teo asks for one thing, and to give it to him you have to take the cave back from the bear.

DAWN

1 Teo's request VIDEO

By the fire under the Elder Tree

Teo can't stop looking south. There is someone he has to wake: Mira, his friend, who was right behind him when he ran. You agree. Two people can't rebuild a world, and her hands could make everything you can't.

MORNING

2 The bear in the cave HURDLE

The Awakening Cave

The bear you drove off in the night has crawled into the cave tunnel to lick its wounds, right between you and the Revonite. You can't fight it in there. Teo's idea: smoke it out. Build a fire at the mouth and pile it with green ferns. When the smoke rolls in, the bear bursts out past you and runs for the hills. Don't stand in its way.

GUIDED The waypoint goes to ferns near the cave, then to the mouth. Teo tells you to stand to one side.

LATE MORNING

3 One more dose

The Nitre Galleries, then your camp fire

You know how this time, and Teo makes it quicker. He shows you the deep beds of bat droppings under the roost, where one scrape gives more nitre than the walls. Saltpetre, Revonite, warm water: one dose.

GUIDED The same steps as Chapter 2, with shorter hints. The card shows only what is still missing.

MIDDAY

4 Mira wakes VIDEO

Just outside the cave mouth

The stone cracks and she screams, arms still up against a light that went out a thousand years ago. Teo catches her. Sitting by the cave, you tell her everything: the stone, the cave, the bear, the green ring. She looks at your clothes and says she'll fix those first.

Part 2 · The lab

Day 1, afternoon to night. Three people, two jobs going at once, and a building you can walk into.

AFTERNOON

5 A place for everything

The Elder Tree

Mira's first question: where do we keep things? Everything you own is in your arms. The plan is a storeroom at the foot of the tree, dry and safe, with racks of sealed clay pots, each one labelled. A lab. You split the work: Teo and Mira make the pots, and you fetch the building materials and the minerals for future doses.

AFTERNOON

6 The expedition NEW TOOL

The forest, the jungle, the galleries

First, a stone axe: flint, a stick, vine and a dab of resin as glue. With it you cut young trees into poles. Then big leaves from the banana plants, vines, and a load of nitre and Revonite for the doses to come. The best Revonite is high on the vein wall, out of reach: make a ladder, as you did for the shelter.

All this time Teo and Mira are working too. A small tracker on your screen shows their progress: *Pots 5 / 12, baking*.

GUIDED One checklist with counts. The waypoint always points at the nearest thing you are still short of.

LATE AFTERNOON

7 Building the lab NEW PLACE

The foot of the Elder Tree, beside the ladder

Five stages, built with E like the shelter: corner posts, a woven wall of sticks, clay pressed into the weave (Mira brings the clay), a thatched roof, and racks inside. It is tall enough to stand up in, with a proper doorway.

EVENING

8 Labelled VIDEO

Inside the lab

Teo and Mira come through the trees with pots hanging from a carrying pole. Mira paints a name on each one (NITRE, SALTPETRE, ASH, REVONITE, FLUID, RESIN, WATER, SEEDS) and they set them on the racks, row by row. Then you brew three doses in the lab's hearth and fill the FLUID pots. From now on you can walk in, look along the shelves, and store or take things.

NIGHT

9 A quiet night

The shelter, made bigger

A calm night after two hard ones. Mira has woven sleeping mats. By the fire she paints the first picture on the lab wall: a man waking in a cave. Teo watches the dark for a long time.

Part 3 · Garron

Day 2. A strong friend for one day, and then an enemy.

DAWN

10 The stone giant VIDEO

The trail into the Elder Tree clearing

Teo is gone at first light. He comes back dragging a sledge of poles and vines, and on it, a stone man twice his width. He found him near the Tiger's Gorge. "Look at him. He could carry logs, fight the bear, protect us."

MORNING

11 Waking Garron

The lab, then the sledge

Take a dose from the FLUID pot (E at the rack) and pour it. Garron wakes calmly, as if he expected it. He asks short, hard questions: how long, how many, who decides who wakes.

DAY

12 Stronger NEW WEAPON

Around the Elder Tree and the jungle trail

For one day he is the best thing that has happened to you. He carries a whole log alone, kills a charging boar with his hands, and teaches you to make and throw a spear. Training with him raises your strength for good: more stamina, and harder hits.

GUIDED He tells you what to bring for the spear (a stave, flint, vine). The kit shows it under Make.

EVENING

13 Two roads VIDEO

The lab

At the fire he says it plainly. No more waking ordinary people: the weak, the old, the greedy who ruined the old world. Only the strong, and everyone else works for him. You want to wake everyone and rebuild everything. The argument ends when he empties the FLUID pots into a bag, knocks you down with one arm, and gives his warning. Then he walks into the jungle.

NIGHT

14 In the jungle VIDEO

Somewhere deep in the jungle

A short scene you see but the others don't. By moonlight Garron pours the fluid over three statues he has chosen: an archer with a drawn bow, a crouched fighter, and a giant. Green cracks spread through the stone. Their eyes open. Cut to black.

Part 4 · The road east

Day 2 night to day 3. Over the mountains, toward the green ring.

NIGHT

15 We can't stay

The lab

He knows where you live, and he has all the fluid. Then Mira smiles and takes down the pot labelled CLAY. Inside is the last of the Revonite. She hid it there when she saw his face. You pack: a checklist of what to take from the shelves, and what you have to leave behind.

GUIDED The lab's shelves light up for each thing on the packing list.

MORNING

16 Over the ridge HURDLE NEW LAND

Past the Lookout, up into the Eastern Pass

A rockslide blocks the trail. You can't lift the boulder, but a long pole over a stone can. Cut a pole, set the stone, and lean on the end.

MIDDAY

17 The ravine HURDLE

The Ravine

An old-world bridge lies in the ravine, its cables rusted through. Mira braids a long rope from plant fibre. You tie it to an arrow and shoot it into a big tree on the far side, tie off your end, and cross hand over hand. Crossing uses stamina, which is where Garron's training pays off.

AFTERNOON

18 Things left behind

The High Meadow

Signs of the old world: a road under the grass, a car turned to a green mound, a sign with half a name on it. A stone hiker with a compass that still points north. From then on your screen shows north. Wild cotton grows here, and Mira sews you a bag that carries more.

DUSK

19 Wolves HURDLE

A rock overhang on the High Meadow

A pack follows you across the meadow as the light goes. Unlike the bear, wolves come from several sides at once. Get to the overhang, light a fire, and hold them off with spear and bow until they give up.

DAY 3

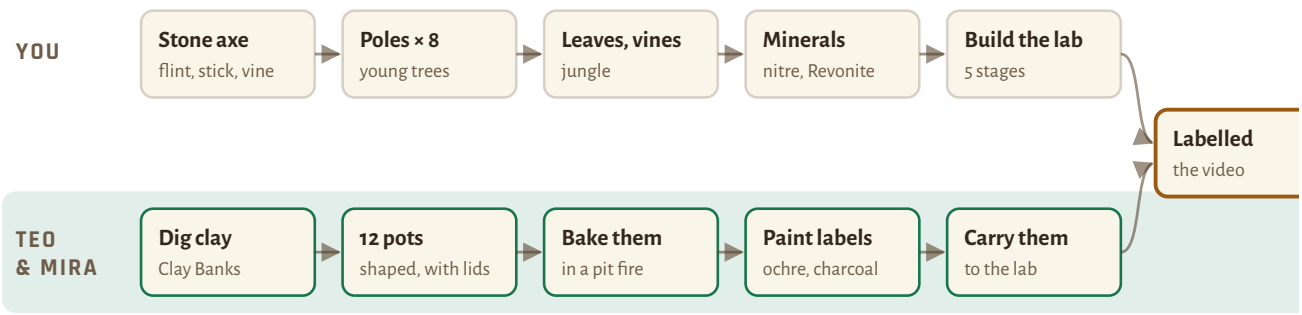
20 The river VIDEO

The River Gorge

The trail drops to a wide, loud river. Across it, on the far bank: rooftops, smoke, and people moving. A bridge of planks and ropes sways over the gorge. The three of you stand at the near end. Chapter 3 ends here. Chapter 4 begins on the bridge.

PART 2, SIDE BY SIDE

Who does what while you are out



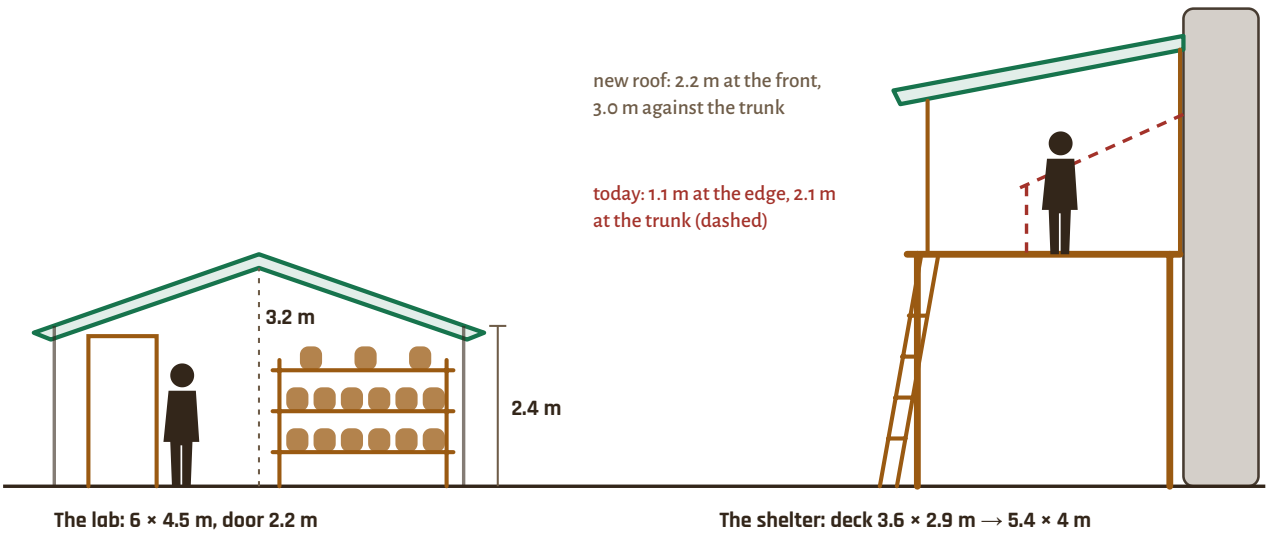
Their row shows on your screen as a small tracker. They also bring the clay for the lab's walls.

ROOM TO STAND

The lab, and a bigger shelter

You asked for buildings that don't make the hero look too big for them. Today the shelter's roof comes down to about 1.1 m above the boards. The hero is 1.8 m tall, so he can't stand up under most of it. Both buildings in Chapter 3 follow one rule:

> **Every roof at least 2.2 m above the floor where you walk, every doorway at least 2.2 m high, and room to turn round inside.** The hero is 1.8 m, so there is always a hand's width or more above his head.



Side views drawn to the same scale (the hero is 1.8 m). Red dashes are today's shelter roof; it cuts across his chest. The bigger shelter is used from Chapter 1 on, so the night in Chapter 1 looks right too. Its building costs stay about the same.

Inside the lab

Two racks of pots along the walls, each pot with a painted name, a bench with a grinding stone, and a small clay hearth by the door for brewing. Firelight from the hearth lights the room, so it never goes black inside. You can walk in, look along the shelves, and press E on a pot to see what is in it, store things, or take them.

What the lab is for

Storage, so you don't have to carry everything. Brewing three doses at once instead of one. And the story: it is what Garron empties, and where Mira hides the last of the Revonite in plain sight.

IN YOUR WAY

The hurdles, and how you get past them

HURDLE	WHERE	HOW YOU GET PAST	WHAT IT TEACHES
The bear in the tunnel	The Awakening Cave	A smoky fire of green ferns at the mouth drives it out. Stand aside.	Smoke: why green leaves smoke and dry wood doesn't
The high seam	The vein hall	Build a ladder (sticks and vines, as in Chapter 1) to reach the rich Revonite.	Using what you already know
Garron	The lab	You can't win this one yet. It is a scene, and he leaves.	That strength isn't the same as being right
The rockslide	The Eastern Pass	A long pole over a stone: a lever. Push on the long end.	Levers: a small push, a big lift
The broken bridge	The Ravine	Mira's rope on an arrow, shot across, tied off, then cross hand over hand. Watch your stamina.	Rope: how twisted fibres hold a person
Wolves at dusk	The High Meadow	Reach the overhang, light a fire, and use the spear and bow. They come from several sides.	Pack hunters, and fire

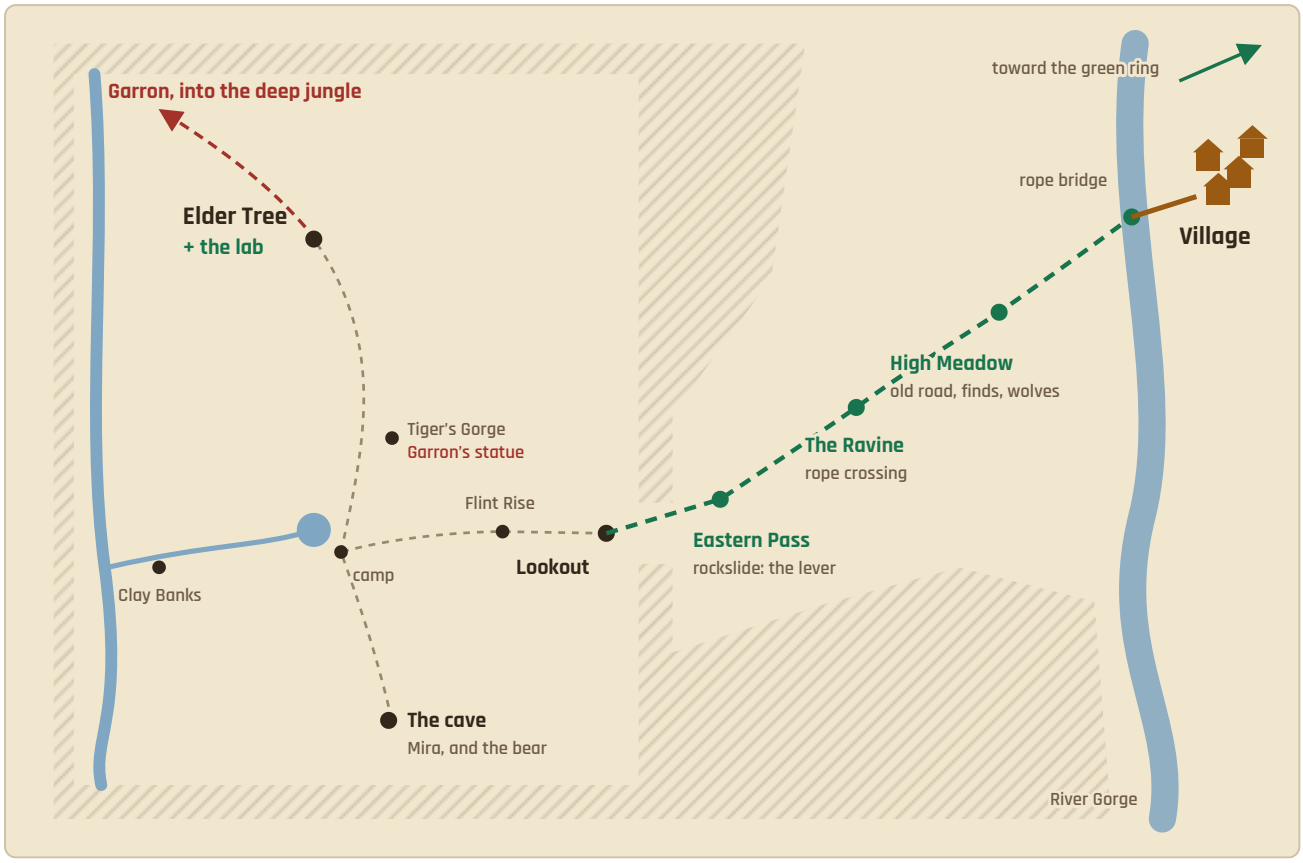
THE KIT

New things to make or find, and where

THING	HOW YOU GET IT	WHERE, OR NEAR WHAT
Stone axe	Kit, Make: 1 flint, 1 stick, 1 vine, 1 resin (the glue)	Flint from Flint Rise; resin from the Elder Tree's bark
Poles	E on a young tree with the axe (2 each)	Thin pale trunks round the Elder Tree and along the forest trail. The waypoint shows the nearest one.
Big leaves, vines	As in Chapter 1	Banana plants in the jungle; vines hanging from jungle trees
Smoky fire	A lit fire plus 6 ferns (E at the fire)	Ferns grow thick round the cave mouth
Nitre (from droppings)	E with the blade on the dark beds	Under the bat roost in the vein hall. Teo points them out.
Ladder	Built in place with E: 6 sticks, 3 vines	Against the vein wall
Clay pots × 12	Teo and Mira make them	You don't need to do anything; the tracker shows how far along they are
Spear	Kit, Make: 1 stave, 1 flint, 1 vine (Garron shows you)	A stave comes from a sapling, as for the bow
Lever	A pole, set over a stone with E	At the rockslide; stones lie beside it
Rope	Give Mira 8 fibre; she braids it	Yellow grass, as before; plenty on the way up to the pass
Rope arrow	Kit, Make: 1 arrow, 1 rope	Shoot it at the big tree across the ravine
Compass	Found on the stone hiker (E)	The High Meadow, by the old road
Bag	Give Mira 6 wild cotton; she sews it. You carry more.	White cotton plants on the High Meadow

THE WAY OUT

The valley, and new land to the east



A sketch, not to scale. The valley is the map you know; everything right of the mountain wall is new. North is up.

NEW PLACE	WHAT IT IS
The lab	A walk-in storeroom at the foot of the Elder Tree, built by you in step 7
The Eastern Pass	The goat trail from the Lookout keeps climbing, through a gap in the mountain wall
The Ravine	A deep cut with a fallen old-world bridge at the bottom
The High Meadow	Open grassland over an old road; the hiker, the stone car, cotton, and wolves
The River Gorge	A wide river in a gorge, and the village on the far bank. Seen in this chapter, entered in Chapter 4.

NEVER CLUELESS

How every step is guided

The card and the waypoint

As in Chapter 2: a checklist with counts, and a marker on screen and on the map pointing at the nearest thing you still need.

Your friends speak up

If you go a minute or so without making progress, Teo or Mira tells you the next step in a line of their own ("The ferns by the cave mouth will smoke well").

The tracker

When Teo and Mira are working somewhere else, a small line on screen shows what they are doing and how far along they are.

Mira's map

Before you leave, Mira paints the way east. The new land shows on your map as painted outlines before you have been there.

The kit and the lab

Every new recipe is in the kit with where to find each part. Inside the lab, the shelves show what is stored, and light up for the packing list.

Field notes

New illustrated pages for each new idea, as before (see below). The card always names the page that explains the step.

FIELD NOTES

The explaining, Dr. Stone style

1. **Smoke.** Why green leaves smoke and dry wood doesn't, and why animals run from it.
2. **Nitre from droppings.** How bat and bird droppings became saltpetre beds, and why people dug them for centuries.
3. **The stone axe.** Fitting a stone head to a handle: lashing, and resin glue.
4. **Walls of sticks and mud.** Wattle and daub, used for thousands of years.
5. **Paint from the earth.** Mira's colours: red and yellow from iron-rich clay, black from charcoal, white from ash, with resin to bind them.
6. **Keeping things.** Why sealed, labelled clay pots keep salts dry and safe.
7. **The spear.** Why a longer arm throws harder.
8. **Levers.** Moving a boulder with a pole and a stone.
9. **Rope.** How twisting short fibres together makes something you can hang from.
10. **The compass.** Why a magnetised needle points north, even after a thousand years.

UNDER THE HOOD

What has to be built

Companions

Teo grows into a proper companion system: Mira and Garron walk, follow, work at a spot, carry things, sit and talk.

Builds on Teo from Chapter 2

The lab

A building you make in stages, with a walk-in room, shelves, painted labels, firelight inside, and storage.

Builds on the shelter and the fire

The bigger shelter

Larger deck, higher roof, room for three to sleep. Also used in Chapters 1 and 2.

Changes the existing shelter

Seven videos

Teo's request, Mira waking, Labelled, the stone giant, Two roads, the jungle, and the river.

Same cinematic system as Chapter 2

New land

A strip of new terrain east of the Lookout, joined to the valley: pass, ravine, meadow, gorge, and the village seen from a distance.

New: the biggest single piece

New animals and moves

Smoking out the bear, a boar, a wolf pack, the lever, and the rope crossing.

Builds on the tiger and bear

BUILDING IT

In this order

1. **The bigger shelter**, and the height rule for every building `small`
2. **Companions:** Mira and Garron, built the way Teo was, plus the tracker `medium`
3. **Part 1:** the bear in the cave, one more dose, Mira wakes `medium`
4. **Part 2:** stone axe and poles, the expedition, building the lab, the inside of the lab and its storage, Labelled, the quiet night `large`
5. **Part 3:** the stone giant, Garron's day, the spear and training, Two roads, the jungle scene `large`
6. **Part 4:** the new land, the lever, the rope crossing, the finds, the wolves, the river and the village `largest`
7. **Field notes, saves, and a full run** by the test bot that plays only by following the guidance `medium`

You can play each part as it is finished. The save carries on from your Chapter 2 save, and the title's Continue button opens Chapter 3 once it exists.

YOUR TURN

Questions for you

1. **Names.** Mira for the artist and Garron for the stone giant? And should the hero have a name now that there are four people talking?
   Suggested: Mira and Garron; give the hero a short name (for example Ren) that the others can call out.

2. **The village.** Living people across the river, or a whole village of statues?
   Suggested: living people. Someone else has woken people too, and that pulls you straight into Chapter 4.

3. **The title.** "Two Roads" (his way and yours), or keep "The Stone Road", which the Chapter 2 end screen already shows?
   Suggested: Two Roads. I would update the end screen to match.

4. **Garron and the player.** Should you be able to fight him (and lose), or is the argument only a scene?
   Suggested: a scene, ending with him knocking you down. A fight you can't win feels unfair.

5. **The wolves.** Keep the dusk fight on the journey, or go straight from the meadow to the river?
   Suggested: keep it, short. It is the journey's one real danger.

> Reply with your answers and any changes to the story (add, cut, or move steps), and I'll start with the bigger shelter.